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On 11 February, just three days before resigning, Kejriwal ordered FIRs to be filed against India's richest man Mukesh Ambani, the present and former petroleum ministers, Veerappa Moily and Murli Deora, and senior government officials, accusing them of wrongfully increasing natural gas prices in the country. In a press conference, which was carried live across the media, he claimed that the Centre's decision to raise gas prices had led to a windfall profit of Rs 54,000 crores for Reliance Industries Limited.

This was not the first time that Kejriwal had openly targeted the Ambanis. In late 2012, Kejriwal had addressed two press conferences accusing Mukesh Ambani of holding black money in Swiss bank accounts and artificially lowering production in its gas wells in the Krishna–Godavari basin to blackmail the government into raising gas prices.

A central figure in those press meets and in the attack on the Ambanis was Prashant Bhushan, a Supreme Court lawyer and senior member of the AAP. A fierce activist, Bhushan was a pugnacious lawyer, always itching for a fight. He was known to pick up seemingly unpopular causes. He had appeared in defence of Naxal sympathizers, Kashmiri separatists and anti-Narmada Dam activists. He had even been physically assaulted by fringe Hindu right-wing groups for his remarks calling for a plebiscite in Kashmir. He also seemed to have an almost pathological dislike for big business, which he was convinced was steeped in cronyism and corruption. It was Bhushan who had taken up the gas price issue against the Ambanis in a PIL that had been filed in the court. Now, wearing his AAP cap, Bhushan was preparing to convert the legal battle into a political war. 'The attack on the Ambanis was originally Prashant's idea,' claims a senior AAP member.

The move suited Kejriwal perfectly. Clearly eyeing the general elections, he was looking for a headline-grabbing issue that would position him as an alternative to both the Congress and the BJP. Kejriwal wanted to show that the Congress and the BJP were two sides of the same coin in the war on corruption. The Ambanis and gas prices became his entry point into the